

Sultant Of Oman
Ministry of Health
Royal Hospital



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Sultanate of Oman
Ministry of Health
The Royal Hospital
Department of Pharmacy

Code: PH-POL-2-Vers.1.1

Effective Date: 01/07/2024

Target Review Date: 01/07/2028

Title: Converting drug administration from IV to Oral

Introduction:

Choosing the route of any medication administration depends on a number of factors, including availability of medications and patient condition. Due to safety and convenience the oral route(PO) is preferred over intravenous (IV) route.⁽¹⁾

Purpose:

This policy provides a guide for healthcare professionals for the conversion of medications from IV to PO route whenever feasible.

Scope:

The policy applies to all patients admitted in Royal Hospital. All staff at the Royal Hospital must comply with this policy.

This criteria for conversion from IV to PO must be followed once the patient fits the criteria and should be based on the clinical judgment of the treating team.

1. Criteria for switching from IV to Oral:

1.1 Eligible patients:

- Clinically improving
- Can tolerate oral feeding or enteral feeding
- Able to adequately absorb oral medications via the oral, gastric tube, or NG tube route

1.2 Ineligible Patients:

The following criteria are for patients who should not be considered for switching from IV to PO.

- Persistent nausea and vomiting and/ or diarrhea
- Patient with the following GI conditions:
 - Ileus or suspected ileus with no active bowel sounds
 - Malabsorption syndrome
 - Small intestine proximal resection
 - High nasogastric (NG) tube output or requiring continuous GI suction (>500mL/day)
 - Active GI bleed
- Cystic fibrosis
- Grade III or IV mucositis
- Wernicke's encephalopathy (for thiamine interchange)
- Acute pain (for IV Paracetamol interchange)
- Myxedema coma or if endocrine consulting (for IV levothyroxine)
- List of conditions in which IV treatment is required i.e., endocarditis, Staphylococcal bacteraemia, osteomyelitis, etc^(1,2)

1.3 For antibiotic switching criteria refer to antibiotics IV to Oral Policy which can be accessed through the royal portal using the following path:

Hospital documents > medicine > infectious disease > policy.

References

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication	Page
1. Switch from intravenous to oral therapy: A concise overview Journal of Pharmacology & Pharmacotherapeutics	Cyriac J, M and James E	2014 Apr-Jun; 5(2)	83-87
2. Medications Monitoring: Intravenous to Oral Therapeutic Interchange Program Sanford Hospital and Clinics Pharmacy Department Policies and Procedures	Sanford Hospital and Clinics	Feb 2013	

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